CAREER ACTION PLAN

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BS Applied AI & Data Science · IIT Jodhpur · Semester 3

Phase 1: Land a Data Annotation job now (alongside exam prep) · Phase 2: Land an internship after Semester 3 ends

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TL;DR — YOUR NEXT 90 DAYS AT A GLANCE

Now → Exam	Sign up for 2 annotation platforms · 30 min/day · earn $50-200 while prepping for exams
Exam Month	Pause annotation · focus fully on Semester 3 exams · keep accounts warm
Post-Exam (1 wk)	Build ONE small portfolio project in 5-7 days · push to GitHub with README
Post-Exam (2-4 wk)	Apply to 15-20 internships/week on Internshala, Wellfound, LinkedIn
Semester 3 Ends	You should have: 1 project, annotation income, 30+ applications sent

1. PHASE 1 — DATA ANNOTATION JOB (START THIS WEEK)

This is the smartest move you can make right now. Annotation work is fully flexible, paid per task (not per hour), requires no interview, and you can do 30-60 minutes between study sessions. Most platforms pay $15-40/hr equivalent once you get fast. Companies need people who actually understand ML concepts to label training data, evaluate model outputs, and write prompts — your IIT AI&DS background is a real advantage here.

Platform Priority List

Platform	Pay Range	Effort to Start	Why It Fits You
DataAnnotation.tech	$20-40/hr	Medium (assessment)	Coding-aware tasks · best pay · ML eval work
Outlier.ai	$15-25/hr	Easy	AI trainer role · flexible hours · India-friendly
Scale AI (Remotasks)	$15-25/hr	Easy	Lots of tasks · good for beginners · paid per task
Toloka	$5-15/hr	Very easy	Lower pay but always has work · good warmup
Amazon MTurk	$2-10/hr	Very easy	Last resort · low pay · only if bored

Step-by-Step Action Plan (This Week)

Day 1 — Sign up for DataAnnotation.tech

Use your IIT Jodhpur email if possible (looks more legit). Complete the onboarding assessment carefully — it tests basic coding + reasoning. Take 60-90 min, no rush. Quality here unlocks the higher-paying coding tasks.

Day 2 — Apply to Outlier.ai

Outlier is hiring "AI Trainers" in India actively. Select "Coding" and "Math" as your domains during onboarding. They pay weekly via PayPal/Payoneer.

Day 3 — Sign up for Remotasks (Scale AI)

Complete the basic training modules. Start with the simplest task types (image bounding boxes, text classification) to build a quality score. Higher score unlocks better-paying tasks.

Day 4 — Set up payment

Create a Payoneer account (works in India, low fees). Link it to all three platforms. PayPal also works but Payoneer has better conversion rates for USD→INR.

Day 5-7 — Do your first tasks

Aim for 2 hours total across the week. Don't chase money yet — chase a high quality score. Speed comes after accuracy. By end of week, you should have your first $20-50 earned.

> **Realistic monthly earnings:** ₹5,000 - ₹20,000 if you do 1-2 hours/day. Enough to fund your own Udemy courses, books, or a domain for your portfolio. Do NOT sacrifice exam prep for this — exam CGPA matters more for internship shortlisting.

2. PHASE 2 — EXAM MONTH STRATEGY (NEXT 30 DAYS)

During exam month, do NOT add new commitments. Keep your annotation accounts "warm" with 1-2 short tasks per week (15 min each) so your quality score doesn't decay. Everything else is exam focus. Your CGPA at the end of Sem 3 will be the single biggest internship filter — recruiters at top companies shortlist based on CGPA before reading your resume.

Annotation	15-30 min/week only · keep accounts active · no new platforms
Exam prep	6-8 hours/day · make a subject-wise schedule TODAY
Sleep	7 hours minimum · don't burn out for short-term money
Portfolio	Don't touch it · you'll have time after exams
LinkedIn	Post 1 short update during exam month (e.g. "Sem 3 exams in progress")

3. PHASE 3 — POST-EXAM 7-DAY PROJECT SPRINT

The single biggest gap in your portfolio right now is "no real project on GitHub." Once exams end, dedicate 7 days to building ONE small but real project. Don't try to do 5 — pick one, finish it, ship it. Here's a realistic plan:

Day 1	Pick dataset from Kaggle (e.g., Titanic, Netflix titles, IPL matches) · write problem statement
Day 2	Data cleaning in pandas · save cleaned CSV · commit to GitHub
Day 3-4	EDA + 4-5 charts with matplotlib/seaborn · commit each chart
Day 5	Build a Streamlit dashboard (1-2 hours · super easy)
Day 6	Write README.md with screenshots, install steps, and what you learned
Day 7	Deploy to Streamlit Community Cloud (free) · add link to resume + portfolio

> **Project ideas that take <7 days each:**
> 1. **IPL Player Performance Dashboard** — pull data from Kaggle, build Streamlit app showing player stats
> 2. **Netflix Viewing Analyzer** — upload your Netflix history, get insights + viz
> 3. **Resume Screener (Mini)** — small NLP app that scores resume vs job description
> 4. **Stock Price Predictor (Toy)** — simple linear regression on Nifty 50 data
> 5. **COVID Trend India Dashboard** — public health data + interactive charts

4. PHASE 4 — INTERNSHIP HUNT (AFTER SEM 3 ENDS)

Start applying the DAY your exams end. Most students wait 2-3 weeks "to prepare" — that's 2-3 weeks of lost opportunities. Apply first, prepare on the fly. Here's where to apply and how:

Where to Apply (in priority order)

Platform / Channel	Best For	Action
Internshala	Indian startups · 2-6 month internships	Set up alerts for "Data Analyst", "Python", "BI" — apply to 5/day
Wellfound (AngelList)	Startups · remote · equity options	Build profile · apply to 3-5 startups/week · startup jobs convert fast
LinkedIn Jobs	Corporate roles · MNCs · brand reach	Turn on "Open to Work" · message recruiters directly · 10 applications/
Naukri.com	Traditional Indian companies	Less exciting but high volume · upload resume · set alerts
IIT Jodhpur CDC	Companies specifically recruiting at IIT Jodhpur	Check WEEKLY · highest conversion rate · alumni referrals
Direct cold email	Startups you admire	Find founder on LinkedIn · send 4-line email · 5/week

Weekly Application Cadence (First 4 Weeks)

Mon-Fri	Apply to 5 internships/day (15 min each) · 25/week total
Mon-Fri	Send 2 cold emails/day to startup founders · 10/week total
Sat	Refine resume · update portfolio · 1 LinkedIn post about your project
Sun	Rest · review what worked · plan next week's targets

> **Realistic conversion math:** 100 applications → ~15 callbacks → ~5 first rounds → ~2 final rounds → **1 offer**. Don't get discouraged. The funnel works.

5. WHAT TO PREPARE FOR INTERNSHIP INTERVIEWS

SQL	Practice 30 problems on HackerRank (easy + medium). Know JOINs, GROUP BY, window functions.
Python	Be able to write a function to clean a messy CSV using pandas · practice live coding
Statistics	Mean/median/mode, normal distribution, p-value, correlation vs causation
Case study	Be ready for "How would you analyze X?" questions · structure your answer out loud
Dashboard tool	Build 1 sample dashboard in Power BI or Tableau · have screenshots ready
Behavioral	STAR method · prepare 3-4 stories (project, teamwork, problem you solved)
Your project	Know it cold · be able to explain every decision + what you'd do differently

FINAL CHECKLIST — PIN THIS TO YOUR WALL

- ☐ Sign up for DataAnnotation.tech, Outlier.ai, Remotasks (THIS WEEK)
- ☐ Set up Payoneer account for international payments
- ☐ Keep annotation warm during exam month (15 min/week max)
- ☐ Crack down on Semester 3 exams — protect your CGPA
- ☐ Day after exam ends: pick ONE project idea, start building
- ☐ 7 days later: deploy to Streamlit Cloud + GitHub link to resume
- ☐ Apply to 25 internships/week for 4 weeks straight
- ☐ Send 10 cold emails/week to startup founders
- ☐ Post 1 update/week on LinkedIn about what you're learning
- ☐ Reach out to IIT Jodhpur seniors/alumni for referrals

One line summary: Earn small money now (annotation), protect your CGPA (exams), build one real project (7-day sprint post-exam), then aggressively apply to internships. By end of Semester 3, you should have income, a project, and 100+ applications sent.